新题型 TEST FOR ENGLISH MAJORS (2026)
-GRADE EIGHT -

TIME LIMIT: 150 MIN

PART I LISTENING COMPREHENSION [25 MIN]

SECTION A MINI-LECTURE

In this section you will hear a mini-lecture. You will hear the mini-lecture ONCE ONLY. While listening to the mini-lecture, complete the gap-filling task on ANSWER SHEET ONE and write NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS for each gap. Make sure what you fill in is both grammatically and semantically acceptable. You may use the blank sheet for note-taking.

You have THIRTY seconds to preview the gap-filling task.

Now, listen to the mini-lecture. When it is over, you will be given THREE minutes to check your work.

（本部分试题见 p. 9）

SECTION B INTERVIEW

In this section you will hear ONE interview. The interview will be divided into TWO parts. At the end of each part, five questions will be asked about what was said. Both the interview and the questions will be read ONCE ONLY. After each question there will be a ten-second pause. During the pause, you should read the four choices of A, B, C and D, and mark the best answer to each question on ANSWER SHEET TWO.

You have THIRTY seconds to preview the choices.

Now, listen to Part One of the interview. Questions 1 to 5 are based on Part One of the interview.

1. A. Nelson as a director.
B. Nelson as a teacher.
C. Nelson as a writer.
D. Nelson as an actor.

2. A. It is nowhere to be found.
B. It is still in his drawer.
C. It was finished.
D. It was published long ago.

3. A. Modern literature.
B. Greek mythology.
C. Classic literature.
D. Modern films.

4. A. His teaching experience.
B. His acting experience.
C. People around him.
D. Interesting incidents.

5. A. They appear in his dreams.
B. They communicate with him.
C. They are like his friends.
D. They live with him virtually.

Now, listen to Part Two of the interview. Questions 6 to 10 are based on Part Two of the interview.

6. A. It is not necessary in creative writing.
B. It is essential in creative writing.
C. It depends on the type of writing.
D. It depends on the type of character.

7. A. The characters start moving backwards.
B. The characters are physically distinct.
C. The characters show weird habits.
D. The characters stop speaking naturally.

8. A. He does physical exercise.
B. He jogs every day.
C. He composes music.
D. He calls his friends regularly.

9. A. By writing on paper.
B. By camping alone.
C. By keeping a strict routine.
D. By working with colleagues.

10. A. He likes to work by himself.
B. He likes to keep himself lonely.
C. He likes to have discussion.
D. He likes to work in an office.

PART II READING COMPREHENSION [45 MIN]

SECTION A MULTIPLE CHOICE QUESTIONS

In this section there are three passages followed by fourteen multiple choice questions. For each multiple choice question, there are four suggested answers marked A, B, C and D. Choose the one that you think is the best answer and mark your answers on ANSWER SHEET TWO.

PASSAGE ONE

(1) Sally Brown, who was born in Vermont in the early 1800s, had a typically varied schedule for a working woman of the time. As her diary shows, one day she is finishing stockings; another she is milking a cow; another she is refining wool. All of her jobs were done from home.

(2) The shift from offices to kitchen tables among white-collar workers in 2020 seems unprecedented, and only possible with the Internet. But it is nothing new. Indeed, the history of home-working suggests some surprising parallels with today.

(3) It is not easy to put exact numbers on how many people have worked from home during different historical periods. Even in Britain, where economic data reach farther back than in any other country, little reliable labour-force data exist until the mid-1800s. Other sources left clues, however. One relates to the meaning of the word "house". Today it connotes domesticity. But up until the 19th century it had a much broader definition, with the suffix "-house" encompassing economic production, too. In "A Christmas Carol", Scrooge works in a "counting-house". Architecture offers other hints. In Britain, many 18th-century houses still have unusually large upstairs windows; cloth-weavers, who worked there, needed as much light as they could get.

(4) Around 1900 French administrators took the lead in asking people about their place of work, not only what they did. They found that one-third of France's manufacturing workforce worked from home. Danish surveys around the same time found that a tenth of the total workforce did so full-time at home. These research efforts took place *at the high point of the factory-based system of production*; in previous decades the share of home-working would have been far higher. According to one estimate for North America, using official data, in the early 1800s more than 40% of the total workforce laboured from home. Only by 1914 did the majority of the labour force work in an office or factory.

(5) The emergence of an at-home industrial workforce had two main causes. The growth of global trade and the rise in per-person income from the 1600s onwards raised demand for manufactured goods such as woolens and watches. But the emerging new technology was more suited to small-scale working than large-scale factories.

(6) What emerged was called the "putting-out system". Workers would collect raw materials, and sometimes equipment, from a central depot. They would return home and make the goods for a few days, before giving back the finished articles and getting paid. Workers were independent contractors: they were paid by the piece, not by the hour, and they had little if any guarantee of work week to week.

(7) Accounts of what it was actually like to work from home in the 18th and 19th centuries are few and far between. Many putting-out workers were women, who were less likely to write autobiographies. Some characteristics nonetheless emerge from the archives. Unlike today, where most people have one job, people moved from one task to another, depending on where money could be made, like Sally Brown.

(8) Some economic historians suggest that workers were mercilessly exploited under the putting-out system. Those who owned the machines and raw materials enjoyed enormous power over those they employed. With workers dispersed across an area, it was difficult for them to team up against exploitative bosses to demand better pay, let alone form trade unions. Bosses "could easily gang up against the rural spinner who faced a take-it-or-leave-it offer of work," argue Jane Humphries and Ben Schneider of Oxford University, in a paper from 2019.

(9) As a result, some historians welcome the development of the factory system from the late 18th

century onwards. Workers moved from a place where domestic life intermingled freely with economic production to a place solely dedicated to the pursuit of efficiency. It is hardly surprising that labour productivity was higher in the factory, now that the factory system gradually outperformed the putting-out system and came to replace it. Crammed together in a factory, workers could more easily club together to ask for higher wages; trade unions started to grow from the 1850s onwards. According to English data, factory workers were paid 10-20% more than home-workers.

(10) But is that the whole story? Some home-workers resisted the shift to the factory system—most notably by joining the Luddites, a society of English textile workers in the 19th century who smashed up machines which they perceived were putting them out of a job. Another explanation is that factory owners, at least in the short term, had little option but to offer higher wages in order to entice workers from their homes. *That* suggests that home-working had its advantages.

(11) Home-workers in rural or semi-rural areas could forage for fuel and food, and so boost their meagre incomes. One observer in 1813 noted that women in Surrey, a county close to London, were making three shillings a week from cutting down heath to make brooms—"miserable productions and trifling employments", in his view. But three shillings a week was not far off average female earnings at the time.

(12) Home-workers also had more control over their time. So long as the work was done to the required standard and on time, they were not told exactly when or how to do it. That was in sharp contrast to the factory, where every aspect of life was planned in advance and workers were closely monitored. And home-workers could decide on the exact mix between work and leisure—in contrast to factory workers, who either worked the 12- or 14-hour days stipulated by the factory owner or none at all. Average working hours in the 18th century were shorter than they became in the 19th. After drinking heavily on Sunday evening, homeworkers often took the day off before they went "reluctantly back to work Tuesday, warmed to the task Wednesday, and laboured furiously Thursday and Friday", as David Landes, an economic historian at Harvard University, put it.

(13) In 1920 Max Weber, a German sociologist, argued that the separation of the worker's place of work from their home had "extraordinarily far-reaching" consequences. The factory was more efficient than the home-based system which had preceded it—but it was also a space in which workers had less control over their lives, and where they had much less fun. Depending on how permanent it proves to be, today's shift back to the home could have similarly far-reaching effects.

11. Which of the following is mentioned as a clue of working from home according to Para. 3?

A. The words with suffix "-house" in literature.

B. The huge upstairs windows of old British houses.

C. The precise labour-force data recorded in Britain.

D. The rising number of workers in the 19th century.

12. What can be inferred from the surveys and estimates in Para. 4?

A. Most people began to work in factories and offices.

B. Danes were more willing to work from home than the French.

C. Quite a number of people still worked from home.

D. The technology then was more suited to working at home.

13. Which of the following about the putting-out system is CORRECT?

A. Workers had flexible working time.

B. Workers got good pay every week.

C. Male workers outnumbered female workers.

D. There were trade unions for the workers.

14. What is the author's overall tone when he discusses working from home?

A. Supportive.

B. Objective.

C. Opposed.

D. Indifferent.

15. Which of the following is the best title of the passage?

A. Consequences of home-working.

B. Feasibility of home-working.

C. Features of home-working.

D. History of home-working.

PASSAGE TWO

(1) Ancient Chinese paintings can be traced back to as early as 5,000 to 6,000 years ago, when people began to use minerals to draw simple pictures resembling animals, plants, and even human beings on rocks and produce drawings of amazing designs and decorations on the surface of potteries and later bronze containers. However, only a few of the works have survived over time. The earliest drawings that have been preserved till today were produced on paper and silk, which were burial articles with a history of over 2,000 years.

(2) As far as the subject is concerned, Chinese paintings fall into several categories, such as figure paintings, landscapes, and flower-and-bird paintings. European paintings, introduced into China in the 17th century, were called "Western paintings," and the traditional local works, "the Chinese paintings." As the reoresentative of Eastern paintings, Chinese paintings greatly differ from the Western counterpart in terms of contents, forms, and styles.

(3) In terms of drawing skills, Chinese paintings can be categorized into two styles: colored paintings and water-ink paintings, with the former dominant before the 12th century by professional or craftsman painters, and the latter in and after the 12th century by literati (文人学士) painters. Also known as "fine-stroke" paintings, colored paintings feature close attention to details and fine brushwork. Thanks to the mineral-made dyes, the original colors can be fully maintained and the paintings will not fade away as time goes by. Colored paintings, which manifest in themselves unparalleled graceful air, were widely welcomed among the painters serving in royal courts. On the contrary, water-ink paintings, also called "thick-stroke" paintings, are supposed to convey spiritual resonance with strokes as simple as possible, instead of attaching much importance to the realistic subjects. Exaggerated forms, such as generalization and hyperbole as well as rich imagination, are employed in painting to display painters' feelings. Therefore, it is relatively difficult to make a copy of a water-ink painting. However, there is no absolute line between the two schools. No matter which school they belonged to, painters could and did compromise a little and learn from each other, giving rise to a mixed style including elements from both.

(4) Traditional Chinese paintings perfectly integrate poetry, calligraphy, painting, and seal engraving, all of which are necessary components. As Chinese is an ideographic language system, most of the Chinese characters in ancient times were produced with concise strokes according to the shapes or meanings of the signified, which naturally generated an artistic form of calligraphy closely connected with painting. Chinese painters, in particular literati painters, would unconsciously draw with the styles of calligraphy. Writing poems became an established way to express their feelings during the process of drawing. In the end, according to the tradition of Chinese literati, red seals with their names engraved were used to sign their works, a tradition that continues to this day.

(5) Chinese paintings clearly reveal that Chinese think in a holistic way. Before drawing, painters must have an overall planning concerning the content of poems, the style of calligraphy, and the place where the works should be signed. The criterion of "Painting in poetry and poetry in painting" for excellent works was originally set by Su Shi, the well-known painter and writer in the Northern Song Dynasty. Other painters later held this idea in high esteem. An obvious distinction between Chinese and European paintings lies in the fact that a piece of blank space is always reserved in Chinese paintings for clouds over mountains, fog haunting above rivers, light circles reflected from the sun or the moon, or nothing at all. Some argue that the "blankness" in Chinese paintings is the most appropriate vehicle to convey the uncertainty and ambiguity featured in Chinese poems.

(6) Ample evidence can be found in fine-art archeology that paintings with people as the subject turned out to be the earliest one among all the categories of Chinese paintings and used to enjoy prosperous development. Dating back to the primitive age, ancestors drew pictures of human beings and animals on walls and rocks with white stalks, red bauxite, or charcoal. However, figure paintings didn't get fully developed until 1,500 years ago, when Gu Dangzhi, the famous painter and art theorist, asserted that more attention should be paid

not only to the external shapes of figures, but also the internal quality. This argument was accepted by artists and critics and taken as an established rule guiding the future production and comments of similar works.

(7) As the most important and most influential category among Chinese paintings, the landscape paintings, which came into being much later and developed quickly in the Tang Dynasty, usually take images of natural scenery, such as mountains or rivers, as the subjects. Over the long history of paintings in ancient China, the largest portion of painters specialized in landscapes. Landscape painting could reach its heyday and maintain its dominant role in Chinese paintings, primarily because of its deep root in Chinese traditional culture. Chinese philosophers in ancient times believed in the "unity of nature and man," which means that human beings can feel nature and therefore should be in a harmonious relationship with it. Having widely accepted this argument, Chinese painters tended to integrate their feelings and dreams into the natural scenery they were producing, while arousing aspiration and imagination from readers.

(8) With flowers and grass, bamboos and rocks, birds and beasts, and worms and fish as the major subjects, flower-and-bird paintings are usually viewed and admired by viewers. The most frequently seen pictures feature a combination of flowers and birds, hence the flower-and-bird name. Originally designed for craftwork, flower-and-bird painting eventually established itself as an independent school in the Tang Dynasty. Considered sublime and elegant by literati in ancient China, the so-called "four gentlemen" including plum blossom, orchid, bamboo, and chrysanthemum are the most welcomed subjects in Chinese flower-and-bird paintings.

16. Which of the following statements is CORRECT about Chinese paintings or drawings?

A. Chinese and Western paintings differ slightly in contents.

B. Minerals were used in drawings by ancient people.

C. The earliest drawings we see today are mostly on potteries.

D. Fine-stroke paintings gained popularity after the 12th century.

17. According to Para. 3, water-ink paintings _____.

A. are intended to describe real subjects

B. are easy to be copied or replicated

C. are presented with rich colors

D. are displayed with simple strokes

18. Landscape painting could maintain its dominance in Chinese paintings because of its _____.

A. comparatively short history

B. fast-developing drawing skills

C. link with traditional culture

D. focus on the "blankness"

19. What does the passage primarily discuss?

A. Evolution of Chinese paintings.

B. Ancient painters and their works.

C. Skills of Chinese paintings.

D. Categories of Chinese paintings.

PASSAGE THREE

(1) On weekdays the street was very lively. It woke to its work about seven o'clock, at the time when the newsboys made their appearance together with the day laborers. The laborers went trudging past in a straggling file—plumbers' apprentices, their pockets stuffed with sections of lead pipe, tweezers, and pliers; carpenters, carrying nothing but their little pasteboard lunch baskets painted to imitate leather; gangs of street workers, their overalls soiled with yellow clay, their picks and long-handled shovels over their shoulders; plasterers, spotted with lime from head to foot. This little army of workers, tramping steadily in one direction, met and mingled with other toilers of a different description—conductors and swing men of the cable company going on duty; heavy-eyed night clerks from the drugstores on their way home to sleep; roundsmen returning to the precinct police station to make their night report; and Chinese market gardeners teetering past under their heavy baskets. The cable cars began to fill up; all along the street could be seen the shopkeepers taking down their shutters.

(2) Between seven and eight the street breakfasted. Now and then a waiter from one of the cheap restaurants crossed from one sidewalk to the other, balancing on one palm a tray covered with a napkin.

Everywhere was the smell of coffee and of frying steaks. A little later, following in the path of the day laborers, came the clerks and shop-girls, dressed with a certain cheap smartness, always in a hurry, glancing apprehensively at the powerhouse clock. Their employers followed an hour or so later—on the cable cars for the most part—whiskered gentlemen with huge stomachs, reading the morning papers with great gravity; bank cashiers and insurance clerks with flowers in their buttonholes.

(3) At the same time the school children invaded the street, filling the air with a clamor of shrill voices, stopping at the stationers' shops or idling a moment in the doorways of the candy stores. For over half an hour they held possession of the sidewalks, then suddenly disappeared, leaving behind one or two stragglers who hurried along with great strides of their little thin legs, very anxious and preoccupied.

(4) Toward eleven o'clock the ladies from the great avenue a block above Polk Street made their appearance, promenading the sidewalks leisurely, deliberately. They were at their morning's marketing. They were handsome women, beautifully dressed. They knew by name their butchers and grocers and vegetable men. From his window McTeague saw them in front of the stalls, gloved and veiled and daintily shod, the subservient provision men at their elbows, scribbling hastily in the order books. They all seemed to know one another, *these grand ladies from the fashionable avenue*. Meetings took place here and there; a conversation was begun; others arrived; groups were formed; little impromptu receptions were held before the chopping blocks of butchers' stalls or on the sidewalk around boxes of berries and fruit.

(5) From noon to evening the population of the street was of a mixed character. The street was busiest at that time; a vast and prolonged murmur arose—the mingled shuffling of feet, the rattle of wheels, the heavy trundling of cable cars. At four o'clock the school children once more swarmed the sidewalks, again disappearing with surprising suddenness. At six *the great homeward march commenced*; the cars were crowded, the laborers thronged the sidewalks, the newsboys chanted the evening papers. Then all at once the street fell quiet; hardly a soul was in sight; the sidewalks were deserted. It was supper hour. Evening began; and one by one a multitude of lights, from the demoniac glare of the druggists' windows to the dazzling blue-whiteness of the electric globes, grew thick from street corner to street corner. Once more the street was crowded. Now there was no thought but for amusement. The cable cars were loaded with theatergoers—men in high hats and young girls in furred opera cloaks. On the sidewalks were groups and couples—the plumbers' apprentices, the girls of the ribbon counters, the little families that lived on the second stories over their shops, the dressmakers, the small doctors, the harness makers—all the various inhabitants of the street were abroad, strolling idly from shop window to shop window, taking the air after the day's work. Groups of girls collected on the corners, talking and laughing very loud, making remarks upon the young men that passed them. A band of Salvationists began to sing before a saloon.

(6) Then, little by little, *Polk Street dropped back to solitude*. Eleven o'clock struck from the powerhouse clock. Lights were extinguished. At one o'clock the cable stopped, leaving an abrupt silence in the air. All at once it seemed very still. The only noises were the occasional footfalls of a policeman and the persistent calling of ducks and geese in the closed market. The street was asleep.

(7) Day after day, McTeague saw the same panorama unroll itself. The bay window of his Dental Parlors was for him a point of vantage from which he watched the world go past.

20. Which of the following groups in the morning scene presents both a visual and vocal image?

A. Cable conductors. B. Insurance clerks. C. School children. D. Drugstore clerks.

21. Which of the following implies the narrator's opinion?

A. "plasterers, spotted with lime from head to foot" (Para. 1).

B. "... dressed with a certain cheap smartness" (Para. 2).

C. "... idling a moment in the doorways of the candy stores" (Para. 3).

D. "The only noises were the occasional footfalls of a policeman..." (Para. 6).

22. In depicting the street scenes, Para. 6 _____ Para. 5.

A. is analogous to B. shows similarities with

C. contrasts with D. is a continuation of

23. In describing the street scenes and people, the narrator appeals to all the following senses EXCEPT _____.

A. touch　　B. sound　　C. sight　　D. smell

24. What is the narrator's tone in "... these grand ladies from the fashionable avenue" (Para. 4)?

A. Appreciative.　　B. Ambivalent.　　C. Skeptical.　　D. Sarcastic.

SECTION B SHORT ANSWER QUESTIONS

In this section there are eight short answer questions based on the passages in Section A. Answer each question in NO MORE THAN TEN WORDS in the space provided on ANSWER SHEET TWO.

PASSAGE ONE

25. By "at the high point of the factory-based system of production" (Para. 4), what does the author suggest about home-working?
26. Why was it hard for workers to fight against exploitation?
27. What does the italicized "That" (Para. 10) refer to?

PASSAGE TWO

28. What are the key elements of traditional Chinese paintings according to Para. 4?
29. Summarize the way Chinese painters paint according to Para. 5.

PASSAGE THREE

30. What are the TWO words in Para. 1 that describe walking with tiredness?
31. By "the great homeward march commenced" (Para. 5), what does the narrator suggest about the workers?
32. What figure of speech is used in the sentence "Polk Street dropped back to solitude" (Para. 6)?

PART III LANGUAGE USAGE [15 MIN]

The passage contains TEN errors. Each indicated line contains a maximum of ONE error. In each case, only ONE word is involved. You should proofread the passage and correct it in the following way:

For a <u>wrong</u> word,	underline the wrong word and write the correct one in the blank provided at the end of the line.
For a <u>missing</u> word,	mark the position of the missing word with a " ∧ " sign and write the word you believe to be missing in the blank provided at the end of the line.
For an <u>unnecessary</u> word,	cross the unnecessary word with a slash "/" and put the word in the blank provided at the end of the line.

Example

When ∧ art museum wants a new exhibit,	(1) an
it ~~never~~ buys things in finished form and hangs	(2) never
them on the wall. When a natural history museum	
wants an <u>exhibition</u>, it must often build it.	(3) exhibit

Proofread the given passage on ANSWER SHEET THREE as instructed.

（本部分试题见 p. 10）

PART IV TRANSLATION [20 MIN]

Translate the underlined part of the following text from Chinese into English. Write your translation on ANSWER SHEET THREE.

文化自信是一个国家、一个民族发展中最基本、最深沉、最持久的力量。<u>向上向善的文化是一个国家、一个民族休戚与共、血脉相连的重要纽带。我们教育引导群众特别是青少年更好认识和认同中华文明，增强我们的文化自信。</u>

PART V WRITING [45 MIN]

Read carefully the following two excerpts on the pain of being rejected, and then write your response in NO LESS THAN 300 WORDS, in which you should:

- *summarize the main message of the two excerpts, and then*
- *express your opinions on how you will cope with being rejected in your future career.*

You can support yourself with information from the excerpts.

Marks will be awarded for content relevance, content sufficiency, organization and language quality. Failure to follow the above instructions may result in a loss of marks.

Write your response on ANSWER SHEET FOUR.

Excerpt 1

The pain of being rejected

Any salesperson knows the anxiety of being turned down when they encourage potential customers to purchase their products. The same hurt feelings bubble up when you are excluded from lunch with co-workers or fail to land the job you interviewed for.

Yet for many years, little attention has been paid to the importance of rejection. "It's like the whole field missed this centrally important part of human life," says Mark Leary, a professor of psychology and neuroscience. That's changed over the last decade, as a growing number of researchers have turned their eyes toward this uncomfortable fact of life. "People have realized just how much our concern with social acceptance affects almost everything we do," he says.

As researchers have dug deeper into the roots of rejection, they've found surprising evidence that the pain of being rejected is not so different from the pain of physical injury. Rejection also has serious implications for an individual's psychological state and for society in general. Social rejection can influence emotion, cognition and even physical health.

Excerpt 2

Coping with the pain of being rejected

Rejection is painful for the vast majority of us—being rejected kicks into fears that have been encoded in our DNA since the days we were cave dwellers whose lives depended on social support and group protection from predators and enemies. Even when you rationally know you're going to be fine, instinct says otherwise. That's why we start building crazy "thought trains" that hurtle us down the paths that lead nowhere good—just into a deeper pit of despair than we deserve.

Some experts recommend writing a letter (that you'd never share) to the person(s) who rejected you and describe exactly how their actions hurt you and describe how these actions or words made you feel. Express yourself honestly, knowing no one but you will see the letter. Sometimes, if we go back and read about what caused us distress in specific situations, we can begin to see patterns in events—whether it's a pattern of us making inappropriate choices or seeking the same dead-end goals.

Retrain your brain to see the good in any potentially negative situation so that you're able to find the gold that will feed your forward movement and leave behind the heavy weight of negative self-evaluation.

-THE END-